

Meridian Analytics Inc.

Employee Handbook

A guide to working at Meridian Analytics Inc.

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Meridian Analytics Inc.

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Welcome to Meridian Analytics

Meridian Analytics Inc. was founded in 2011 to help mid-market and enterprise organizations turn raw operational data into decisions they can act on. Today we serve over 400 clients across financial services, logistics, and healthcare from our offices in Portland, Austin, and Raleigh, along with a distributed remote workforce spanning 22 states. This handbook is your primary reference for the policies, benefits, and expectations that shape day-to-day life at the Company.

This handbook does not constitute an employment contract, nor does it alter the at-will nature of employment at Meridian, except where a signed individual agreement or applicable collective bargaining agreement states otherwise. Meridian reserves the right to modify, amend, or discontinue any policy described here at its discretion, with notice provided through official Company channels.

1. Employment Basics

1.1 Employment Classifications

Classification	Description
Regular Full-Time	Scheduled to work 30+ hours per week on an ongoing basis; eligible for full benefits.
Regular Part-Time	Scheduled to work fewer than 30 hours per week; eligible for prorated benefits.
Temporary	Engaged for a defined period or project, typically not to exceed 12 months; not benefits-eligible.
Intern	Engaged for a defined academic term; may be paid or unpaid per applicable law.

1.2 Introductory Period

The first 90 calendar days of employment constitute an introductory period during which new employees receive additional onboarding support and check-ins with their manager and an assigned peer mentor. The introductory period is a period of mutual evaluation and does not change the at-will nature of employment; it also does not extend the timeline for benefits eligibility, which begins on an employee's date of hire.

1.3 Work Hours and Attendance

Standard core business hours are 9:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. local time, Monday through Friday, with a minimum unpaid 30-minute meal break for shifts exceeding six hours. Meridian operates under a hybrid work model: employees assigned to a physical office are expected on-site a minimum of two days per week, as coordinated with their manager, while remote-designated roles are exempt from this requirement.

2. Workplace Conduct

2.1 Code of Conduct

Every employee is expected to act with integrity, treat colleagues and clients with respect, and comply with all applicable laws and Company policy. This includes accurate record-keeping, responsible use of Company resources, and avoidance of conflicts of interest. Employees who become aware of a conflict of interest, whether their own or a colleague's, must disclose it promptly to their manager or to compliance@meridiananalytics.com.

2.2 Anti-Harassment and Non-Discrimination

Meridian is committed to providing a work environment free from discrimination and harassment based on race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, national origin, age, disability, genetic information, veteran status, or any other characteristic protected by law. This policy applies to all aspects of employment, including hiring, promotion, compensation, and termination, and extends to interactions with clients, vendors, and members of the public.

Any employee who believes they have experienced or witnessed harassment or discrimination should report it immediately to their manager, any member of People & Culture, or through the confidential Ethics Hotline at 1-800-555-0199. Reports are investigated promptly, and retaliation against anyone who reports in good faith or participates in an investigation is strictly prohibited.

2.3 Drug and Alcohol-Free Workplace

Employees are prohibited from reporting to work under the influence of alcohol or illegal drugs, or from possessing, using, or distributing such substances on Company premises or while conducting Company business. Moderate alcohol consumption may be permitted at Company-sponsored events at management discretion.

2.4 Dress Code

Meridian maintains a business-casual dress standard for office and client-facing settings. Employees meeting directly with clients, whether in person or by video, are expected to dress in a manner consistent with the professionalism of the engagement. Departments with specific safety or client requirements may issue supplemental dress guidance.

3. Compensation and Performance

3.1 Payroll

Employees are paid on a bi-weekly basis via direct deposit, with pay dates falling on alternating Fridays according to the payroll calendar published each January on the MeridianHR portal. Non-exempt employees must record actual hours worked through the Company timekeeping system by 10:00 a.m. on the Monday following each pay period.

3.2 Performance Reviews

Formal performance reviews are conducted twice annually, in June and December, and inform decisions regarding merit increases, bonuses, and promotions. Managers are expected to provide ongoing, informal

feedback throughout the year in addition to the formal review cycle. New employees receive an initial check-in review at the conclusion of their 90-day introductory period.

3.3 Overtime

Non-exempt employees are compensated at one and one-half times their regular rate of pay for hours worked beyond 40 in a single workweek, in accordance with the Fair Labor Standards Act and applicable state law. All overtime must be pre-approved by a manager except in genuine emergency circumstances.

4. Technology and Information Security

Company-issued laptops, mobile devices, and accounts are provided for business use and remain the property of Meridian Analytics Inc. Incidental personal use is permitted provided it does not interfere with job performance, violate Company policy, or expose the Company to legal or security risk.

- Multi-factor authentication is required on all Company accounts without exception.
- Confidential client data must never be stored on personal devices or personal cloud storage.
- Suspected phishing emails should be reported using the “Report Phishing” button in Outlook.
- Lost or stolen devices must be reported to IT Security within one hour of discovery at security@meridiananalytics.com.
- Installation of unauthorized software on Company devices requires prior IT approval.

5. Separation from Employment

5.1 Resignation

Employees voluntarily resigning are asked, though not required, to provide at least two weeks' written notice to allow for an orderly transition of responsibilities. Exempt employees in leadership roles are encouraged to provide four weeks' notice where possible.

5.2 Final Pay and Benefits

Final wages, including any accrued and unused PTO, are paid in accordance with applicable state law, generally on or before the next regularly scheduled payday. Continuation of group health coverage is available under COBRA, with enrollment information provided by People & Culture within 14 days of the separation date.

5.3 Return of Property

Departing employees must return all Company property, including laptops, access badges, and any physical or digital assets containing confidential information, no later than their final day of employment.

6. Handbook Acknowledgment

All employees are required to acknowledge receipt and review of this handbook through the MeridianHR portal within the first week of employment and upon any material revision. This handbook supersedes all prior versions. For questions not addressed here, please contact your manager or hr@meridiananalytics.com.